Trocar and Cannula



Category: **Animal Husbandry & Dairy** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Trocar and cannula

What it is used for

A trocar and cannula assembly is a veterinary instrument used for controlled access to a body cavity in specific clinical situations, such as relieving ruminal bloat in cattle when indicated. It must be used only by trained veterinary professionals because incorrect placement can cause severe injury, infection, leakage, or death.

Main parts

- Trocar is the pointed instrument used to penetrate tissue.
- Cannula is the hollow sleeve that remains in the access opening.
- Handle provides grip and control during insertion.
- Cannula opening allows gas or fluid to pass where indicated.
- Cap or valve controls the opening where fitted.
- Reusable models may include a locking mechanism to retain the trocar.
- Compatible cleaning and sterilisation accessories support reprocessing where permitted.

Before you start

1. Only a qualified veterinarian or specifically trained personnel acting under veterinary direction should perform the procedure.
2. Confirm the clinical indication, animal identity, condition, and appropriate treatment plan before use.
3. Inspect the trocar, cannula, handle, locking mechanism, and any cap for damage, corrosion, or obstruction.
4. Confirm the instrument is the correct size and design for the intended animal and procedure.
5. Verify that reusable equipment has been cleaned and sterilised according to validated instructions, or that the single-use device is sealed and in date.
6. Prepare the approved site-preparation supplies, PPE, restraint equipment, and emergency support required by the veterinary protocol.
7. Use appropriate animal restraint and ensure trained assistance is available to protect the animal and staff.

How to use

1. Explain the planned procedure to the animal owner or responsible handler and obtain required consent.
2. Assess the animal and confirm that the procedure is appropriate under the veterinary treatment plan.

3. Position and restrain the animal using the approved method while monitoring distress and breathing.
4. Prepare the intended site using the veterinary protocol for cleaning, antisepsis, and any indicated local anaesthesia.
5. Open sterile or properly reprocessed equipment without contaminating the working parts.
6. Verify the trocar fits the cannula and that the assembly operates correctly before use.
7. The qualified veterinarian should locate the correct access site and perform insertion using the established clinical technique.
8. Once access is established, manage the trocar and cannula according to the procedure and veterinary protocol.
9. Monitor the animal closely for worsening distress, bleeding, abnormal discharge, or other complications.
10. Remove the instrument or cannula only when clinically appropriate and according to the veterinarian's plan.
11. Provide the prescribed aftercare, observe the animal, and arrange follow-up or further treatment as required.
12. Dispose of single-use instruments and contaminated materials in designated waste streams; reprocess reusable instruments according to validated procedures.
13. Record the indication, procedure, instrument details where required, animal response, and follow-up plan.

⚠ Safety

- Do not use the instrument without veterinary training, appropriate clinical indication, and suitable restraint.
- Incorrect placement can damage internal organs, blood vessels, or other tissues and may cause life-threatening complications.
- Maintain aseptic technique and use suitable PPE to reduce zoonotic and wound infection risks.
- Do not force the trocar if resistance, unexpected pain, bleeding, or an abnormal response occurs; stop and reassess.
- Keep sharp tips protected during handling, transport, cleaning, and storage.
- Follow local veterinary rules for animal welfare, medicines, infection control, and clinical waste disposal.

Care & storage

- Immediately after use, handle contaminated sharps carefully and place them in a secure designated container for transport to reprocessing.
- Clean reusable instruments promptly according to the manufacturer's instructions so organic material does not dry on them.
- Inspect the point, cannula lumen, handle, and locking mechanism for damage, blockage, or corrosion.
- Sterilise reusable instruments using a validated method compatible with the device.

- Store clean, dry, processed instruments in protective packaging and remove damaged items from service.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using the trocar and cannula without confirming the clinical indication and correct placement site.
- Using inadequately cleaned or non-sterile equipment for an invasive procedure.
- Forcing insertion despite resistance or signs of complications.
- Failing to monitor the animal or provide appropriate aftercare and follow-up.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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